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Sports betting by teens raises addiction fears

Some evade age barriers, helped by unwitting parents

By John Hilliard

GLOBE STAFF

To their usual banter about the latest game or their favorite sports stars, many teenage boys are increasingly drawing from a new and disturbing lexicon: parlays, prop bets, and locks for a guaranteed win.

Since the legalization of online sports betting, young fans are finding

ways to circumvent age restrictions and other safeguards, including by accessing their parents' own betting accounts.

The spread of youth betting has experts and antigambling activists warning that more teens are now vulnerable to lifelong addictions. Data is limited on the impact the newly legalized, multibillion-dollar sports gambling industry is having on young people, but compliance reports filed by sports betting companies FanDuel and DraftKings offer a glimpse into what advocates say is a much larger problem.

Nearly 400 underage users in two

GAMBLING, Page A15

'It's a lot of pressure that your future just lies in the hands of one person.'

CURRENT CITY COUNCIL STAFFER, *speaking anonymously*

For Boston council aides, a tenuous hold on their jobs

Loose work conditions open to misuse

By Niki Griswold

GLOBE STAFF

For most employees of the City of Boston, the vast majority of whom are unionized, sick time, vacation days, and set salary ranges for their positions are a given.

But for the dozens of employees who work for Boston city councilors,

almost none of those basic employment conditions apply.

First, they are all technically considered temporary workers; both their employment and biweekly pay must be publicly reauthorized by the council roughly every three months.

The 13 councilors are not required to provide even a minimum amount of

paid time off, despite staff working long hours, often into the evenings and on weekends. Staff also are not eligible for overtime, nor are there councilwide policies for tracking their hours.

There are no salary minimums or set pay ranges for council staff. So even compensation — as well as job expectations or responsibilities — can

COUNCIL STAFF, Page A14

RIGGED FOR A SHOW



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

More than 50 tall ships and historic military vessels from around the world entered Boston Harbor on Saturday, part of Sail250's touring celebration. Thousands of spectators gathered at vantage points across the city to see the spectacle, including this man at LoPresti Park in East Boston. **B1, B4.**

America's Test Kitchen cites changing market in its reset

By Aidan Ryan

GLOBE STAFF

When private equity-owned Marquee Brands bought America's Test Kitchen in 2023, the new leaders of the Boston food media company assured employees that they hadn't arrived

to make big changes.

At the time, executives spoke at a town hall meeting, as former employees have since recalled to the Globe. The remarks included a pledge not to make changes to personnel, two of them said. Roughly a month lat-

er, however, ATK laid off 23 workers — 10 percent of its workforce — and shuttered ATK Kids, which focused on children's recipes and books.

In the three years since, the company has conducted two additional rounds of layoffs, in-

cluding shuttering its Cook's Country magazine and laying off 24 more employees in May.

The changes at ATK — which also include bringing on influencers, the departure of some longtime employees, and doing

KITCHEN, Page A13

Amid strike, fill-in nurses a flashpoint

Are they vital backstops or union busters?

By Marin Wolf, Sarah Rahal, and Jonathan Saltzman

GLOBE STAFF

It was just after 7 a.m. and time for shift change among the nurses working in the neonatal intensive care unit at Brigham and Women's Hospital.

But rather than the typical collegial handoff, the exchange on Wednesday morning was terse and awkward. The nurses leaving were in a union that was staging a one-day strike

that morning; the ones coming on shift were their replacements, hired from an outside staffing firm that specializes in helping health care institutions during strikes.

"Good luck out there today," one of the replacement nurses said to Kelly Ruffin, a neonatal intensive care unit nurse. Outside the hospital, Ruffin recounted the interaction with the "scabs," a derogatory term for fill-ins for striking workers.

"It was a little insensitive," Ruffin said, then added: "A lot insensitive."

During the largest nursing strike in Massachusetts history, Brigham has been able to

NURSES, Page A15

When it comes to buying a home, is brand-new right for you? There are pros and cons. Address, H1.

The Globe honors the finest high school athletes of the spring season in the All-Scholastics special section.

Sol matey

Sunday: Sunny and nice. High: 76-81. Low: 64-69.

Monday: Sunny, warmer. High: 84-89. Low: 69-74.

Complete report, **A22.**

'But being lost in all the politics is a human story, and an achingly familiar one for survivors. It is the story of how victims of sexual assault must choose between two unimaginably awful options: standing up or staying silent.'

Yvonne Abraham, on the woman who came forward about Graham Platner, **B1.**

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